

Lab 4: Reconcile Accounts and Explain Variances

TGS-2026065050 · Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

Lab 4: Reconcile Accounts and Explain Variances

Course: Generative AI for Finance and Fintech (TGS-2026065050)

Mapping: K1 · A2

Suggested time: 120 minutes

Objective: Apply deterministic matching and Finance Agent-style variance analysis to a month-end close.

Scenario

The controller must reconcile ERP and bank/ledger extracts and explain material monthly movements.

Files

- `northstar-reconciliation-variance-starter.xlsx` - learner working file
- `northstar-reconciliation-variance-solution.xlsx` - completed formulas, controls and charts for review
- `evidence-checklist.md` - submission and verification checklist

Before you begin

- Use only the supplied synthetic data.
- Do not enter live customer, payroll, account, credential or confidential data.
- If the required Microsoft feature is not enabled in your tenant, complete the workbook-based simulation and record the limitation.
- Keep facts, assumptions, AI suggestions and reviewer decisions visibly separate.

Detailed procedure

Step 1: Review the two source tables and control totals.

Record the evidence for Step 1 in the checklist before continuing.

Step 2: Apply exact, reference and tolerance match logic.

Record the evidence for Step 2 in the checklist before continuing.

Step 3: Classify timing items separately from unresolved exceptions.

Record the evidence for Step 3 in the checklist before continuing.

Step 4: Create the reconciliation summary and assign exception owners.

Record the evidence for Step 4 in the checklist before continuing.

Step 5: Prepare a PivotTable-ready variance table with ordered periods.

Record the evidence for Step 5 in the checklist before continuing.

Step 6: Use Finance Agent or Copilot to draft a narrative, then verify every number and remove unsupported causality.

Record the evidence for Step 6 in the checklist before continuing.

Prompt quality pattern

> Role: You are assisting a finance professional. Task: analyse only the named workbook table. Data boundary: do not use external or unstated facts. Controls: reconcile totals, identify missing evidence, and label assumptions. Output: return a concise table of finding, evidence, confidence, reviewer action and source cell or table.

Acceptance criteria

- Matched plus exception values reconcile to each source; all unresolved items have a reason and owner; the narrative cites actual values and materiality thresholds.
- All generated claims have been checked against the workbook or approved knowledge.
- No live credentials, personal data or confidential business data appear in the evidence.
- A human reviewer and approval status are recorded.

Deliverable

A reconciliation report, exception queue and evidence-backed variance narrative.

Reflection

1. What did the AI accelerate?
2. What still required finance judgement?
3. Which control prevented the most serious failure?
4. What evidence is needed before this design can scale?

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